

The Social Radars

S4: Tyler Shultz, Theranos Whistleblower (Part 1)

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Jessica: I'm Jessica Livingston and Carolynn Levy and I are the Social Radars. In this podcast, we talk to some of the most successful founders in Silicon Valley about how they did it. Carolynn and I have been working together to help thousands of startups at Y Combinator for almost 20 years. Come be a fly on the wall as we talk to founders and learn their true stories.

So Carolynn, today we have a very exciting and kind of unexpected guest. Today we have Tyler Schultz who was, as most people will know, one of the very first whistleblowers in the Theranos fraud story. He's the grandson of George Schultz, who was the former Secretary of State, who was also on the Theranos board, and Tyler was an employee at Theranos, fresh out of Stanford and he began to notice some things weren't quite what they seemed at the company and started raising some questions and concerns. Very quickly, things escalated and he became a target of threats and lawsuits and all this stuff at Theranos, and was gaslit. His story is incredible and it's covered in the book, *Bad Blood* by the Wall Street Journal reporter, John Carreyrou, who first broke the story, which is an amazing book and I highly recommend it. And we are thrilled to have you here today, Tyler. Welcome.

Tyler: Yeah, I'm happy to be here. Thanks so much for having me.

Jessica: You're welcome.

Carolynn: So glad you're here, Tyler.

Jessica: I was thinking about this as I reread *Bad Blood* and was just so fascinated by it. I feel like you're crazy stories kind of in two different parts. There's the crazy part where you were at Theranos as an employee and then there was the crazy story after you had resigned and were no longer an employee, right?

Tyler: Yeah. It's funny, on my last day when I left Theranos, I felt like, oh, great, this story's finally over for me. Little did I know, it was just the beginning of the next chapter.

Jessica: Like the horror movie where the creature comes back alive to get you. If we think about it like that, maybe we'll start with part one when you were an employee at the company.

Tyler: To start at the very beginning, to give a little bit of context, I was a junior at Stanford at the time, and my grandfather actually lived and worked on campus. So he actually lived down the street from some fraternity houses, in fact. So one day I got a call from him and he said, "I'm having this brilliant woman come over to my house, and I think you would learn a lot if you came over and listened in on the discussion." So I didn't have a

whole lot of context, but it sounded interesting. So I biked over to his house and that's where I met Elizabeth for the first time. And of course she was wearing her very famous black turtleneck as Carolynn is wearing right now.

Carolynn: It's an homage.

Tyler: Yeah. That did not go unnoticed, don't worry.

Carolynn: By the way, it's also a hundred degrees in the East Bay today, so it's a choice.

Tyler: Wow, wow, wow. Yeah, you're dedicated right now. See how she was wearing this black turtleneck modeled after Steve Jobs. I saw her piercing blue eyes, heard her deep voice that was almost hypnotic. She was the type of person where as soon as she starts speaking, the rest of the room would just go silent. She had this way of just locking in an audience, and when she spoke to you, she made you feel like you were the most important person in her entire world in that moment. She had this amazing ability to make you feel really good and feel connected to her and feel connected to a vision and a mission. And it was incredibly charismatic.

Now, I think when you look back, people go like, wow, this lady was so weird, clearly a psychopath. But at the time, it felt like you were talking to the next Steve Jobs, and that's where I heard her lay out her vision for Theranos, which was that anything a central laboratory could do, her technology could do with just a single drop of blood, and you could do it anywhere you had access to electricity, so you didn't need to be in a laboratory. So you could do these tests in battlefields and medevac helicopters and operating rooms and patients homes and Walgreens and Safeways.

And it just seemed like it had no limitations and that it did truly have the ability to revolutionize the way that we practice healthcare. So I was completely sold. I wanted to be part of this company. I remained in touch with Elizabeth. She kind of became one of my mentors, and she actually urged me to switch my major from mechanical engineering to biology.

Jessica: Oh, wow.

Tyler: So I was a bio major at Stanford for two quarters, but somehow managed to graduate with that on the diploma, and then I went and worked for Theranos, first job out of college.

Jessica: You had interned there though, hadn't you?

Tyler: Yeah, so I interned between my junior and senior year. But overall the internship was very smooth. I was working in a research lab. Retrospectively, the biggest red flag about that internship was that I was working with people who had been there for 3, 4, 5 years and none of them had ever seen the product that we were working on.

Carolynn: Oh, they'd been there long. They'd been working there for that long?

Tyler: Yeah. There were people who had been working there for years who had never seen the product and everything was so siloed. There were locked doors, there were barricades, there were overreaching NDAs. You were told not to talk to coworkers about work, and this was all under the guise of protecting trade secrets. And there were Chinese spies trying to steal their technology, and there were requests at Labcorp who were trying to steal their technology and get ahead of them and figure out what they were doing. And so I kind of bought those reasons at the time, and a lot of startups begin in stealth mode.

Jessica: Not within the company though, Tyler?

Tyler: But see, that's the problem. When you have no reference points, when it's your first real experience outside of a university, you don't really know that that's not normal.

Jessica: And your parting comment from a colleague as you're heading back to Stanford, that was sort of ominous, right?

Tyler: So I did have one colleague and I got along with her really well, and we just happened to eat breakfast at the same time, meet up for lunch, and we did not talk about work. People took that very seriously. She worked in a different lab with a different key. We never talked about work. We were just friends. And I remember on my last day as an intern when I was leaving, she just said, "You shouldn't come back here. You should go somewhere else and learn how to do real science."

Carolynn: Oh shoot.

Tyler: And I was completely taken aback because I felt like I was doing real science in the research lab that I was doing. I wasn't working with the device directly. So I felt like I was part of this big vision in that... I kind of brushed that comment off. I didn't pay all that much attention to it, unfortunately.

Carolynn: What was your lab doing? You said you weren't working on the device, so what were you doing that summer?

Tyler: So we were engineering antibodies that would be used in the blood tests. So we are very far downstream. So we would develop these antibodies. Eventually we would pass them off to the team that would actually develop the test. So then they would use this one reagent to develop the blood test, and then they would pass it off to a team that would validate that blood test and basically say this is safe and effective for patients to use. And then they would pass it off to a production team who would then scale it up and have other types of quality controls. Then they would pass it off to the team that would actually run real patient samples. So that's how far removed my team was.

Carolynn: Got it.

Tyler: So we were working on one small piece, but what was crazy is that every single one of those pass off points, there were intentional impediments to communication, which is crazy. We developed these antibodies, but we were not allowed to talk to the team that

would use those antibodies to develop the test. And you just can't do science that way. It won't work. You can't move fast enough. You can't work in silos like that. And a lot of people refused to. I think a lot of their top employees, they did a really good job of hiring and they did not do a very good job of retaining top talent. Some people would come and in a few weeks they would leave. And that should have been also more of a red flag to me.

Jessica: You were young though. So you go back to college, you finish your senior year, and you have a job at Theranos waiting for you. So then you're in a new department, right?

Tyler: So very quickly, when I came back to work full-time, I was originally put back into the same research lab, but coincidentally, my first day happened to be the day that Theranos launched their product. And so it was a very interesting time to be there. Very exciting time to be there. Literally, Elizabeth did the ribbon cutting ceremony at Walgreens in Palo Alto on Monday, and my first job was the next day, Tuesday morning.

Carolynn: Oh, wow.

Tyler: But on that day, the manager of this assay validation team, which was also called the ELISA Lab, ELISA is the immunoassay. It's a very specific type of blood test. But essentially, her job was to manage the team that validated these blood tests before they could be used on real patients. And on my first day she quit, and I don't really know the whole story.

Carolynn: What?

Tyler: Yeah. On my very first day I was in a group of scientists, someone comes over and says, this person's out in the parking lot crying right now. I was told she had some kind of screaming match with Sunny and Elizabeth, and then was fired and was literally in the parking lot crying. And then my manager pulled our team aside and said that things are crazy in this assay validation team because we just launched the product, but we have zero tests that have been validated on the Theranos platform. But we weren't actually using the product for anything. So if a patient went into Walgreens, first of all, they would not get a finger prick. They would get a needle in their arm the same way you would get at Quest or Labcorp. And then that test would not be run on a Theranos product. It would be sent to other labs, or it would be tested at Theranos on third party equipment that we bought by Siemens or Roche.

Carolynn: And this was all disclosed to you as this was going on, or no?

Tyler: This is my first day.

Carolynn: Yeah. Yes.

Tyler: This was the first day, something is not right. That's the first sign. Something is not right.

Jessica: Hold on. Tyler, just to pile onto Carolynn, you didn't realize that the tests were being tested on Siemens machines, right? Or did you on your first day?

Tyler: At that very moment, I did not know exactly what happened to those blood samples.

Jessica: Okay.

Tyler: On that day, I just knew that we weren't really using the devices that we had supposedly launched.

Carolynn: And are you telling yourself, okay, well, it's a weird first day, things are weird, but it's going to be fine. Or were you like, oh, this may really be bad. How did you measure it?

Tyler: I felt like all was well. It didn't raise as big of a red flag as that should have. And we had an all hands company meeting that same day that was hugely celebratory. People were riding high because we had been in stealth mode for 11 years.

Carolynn: Oh my God.

Tyler: And finally we were launching this product and telling the world about what our mission was. It was incredibly exciting, and I absolutely got caught up in that. So that was my first day. I actually thought that I would work at Theranos for my entire career. I thought I could work there for 30 years and retire. I thought that was the most likely path.

Carolynn: Wow.

Jessica: Wow. Okay. So then bump, bump. Let's talk about some of the red flags you start seeing.

Carolynn: And I have to just remind the audience that you are, what, 22 years old at this time, and this is your first job out of college?

Tyler: Yeah. I think I was 22 when I first started working there. So when more red flags start popping up is when I actually see the device. And that happens because this validation team that I talked about earlier, people were quitting, dropping flies. It was a revolving door. People would come in, they would get burned out, they would leave. This team was literally working through the night. Someone had to be running experiments every hour of the 24-hour day. And Sunny would do walkthroughs of the lab at three in the morning to make sure that there were people in there actually working. And they were just desperate to get a test validated on this platform so that something could be run on the Theranos devices.

And that thing actually did end up happening fairly quickly. So it was probably a matter of days or weeks after we launched that we did get the first test validated on Theranos platform, and that was HbA1C, which is a notoriously very easy test to do. But anyway, so this lab, people are dropping like flies, and we get an email from Sunny, I think on that Friday, so at the end of my first week that said, scrap all of your experiments, all of the research teams are being moved to validation because we just need more people on the

front lines. And it did truly feel like the front lines of the company because the lab that had all these Theranos devices was even named Normandy, which is a questionable name to begin with.

The idea behind the name Normandy was that Theranos was storming the beaches of healthcare, I guess. But really it just felt like it was just not a good place to be. No one wants to be on the beaches of Normandy.

Jessica: And for the people that were, I think like your grandfather who at least fought in World War II, how insulting.

Tyler: That was one of the craziest things. I would've thought that would be very insulting to someone who actually did fight in World War II. Elizabeth was this master marketer and could spin things all kinds of ways, so I think he probably saw that as a positive.

Jessica: Okay. I'm sorry to do this, but Sunny Balwani, was he a wacko from the start? Did you have a bad vibe about him from the very beginning, unlike Elizabeth, who you were enthralled by?

Tyler: I always got a bad vibe from Sunny. I think almost everyone got a bad vibe from Sunny. Even my grandparents, they became very close to Elizabeth. She was coming to our family Christmases and Thanksgivings and birthday parties, and they never wanted to invite Sunny. They only invited Sunny when they absolutely had to because he's just a hard person to be around. I would describe him as having the personality of gravel. He's just a very abrasive person. And what's interesting with all these lawsuits is that we can actually see text messages that are exchanged between Sunny and Elizabeth. And I think that personality really shows now in the public record in the way that he texts. When they discovered that I was a source... Well, first when they were looking for sources, he said things like, "I've narrowed it down to five people. We're going to nail this motherfucker." And then after, Elizabeth says, "It's definitely Tyler." He texted something like, "Knocking legs off one at a time is the best way."

Carolynn: Oh my God.

Tyler: He speaks and acts and talks like a mob boss.

Carolynn: Wow. That's crazy.

Jessica: Yeah. I feel like if I had ever met him, he would be the biggest red flag immediately. I'd be like, something is going wrong at this company if it's sort of being run by him. He waltzed in there and started running it. Right?

Tyler: Yeah. He certainly seemed to be running things on the inside. He was managing the lab. He was the person who was bullying employees to run patient samples despite quality control failures. And I think that was intentionally set up by Elizabeth and Sunny. She wanted to keep this very angelic figure. She was the darling of healthcare of Silicon Valley. She was the youngest self-made female billionaire. She was quote-unquote,

"doing well by doing good". And so I think she wanted to run the company the way Sunny was running it, but she knew that she wanted to be able to preserve this public persona that she had. And that resonated really well with investors and board members and the media. And she wanted to run the company like Apple. And this was, I think, her interpretation of how Steve Jobs ran Apple. And I think to some extent that is true. Apple has a notoriously pretty tough work culture, but I do not think that it was anything like this. I just can't imagine Apple being able to accomplish the things they did running an organization the way that this organization was run.

Jessica: Which was filled with threats, bullying and lies and gas lighting, right?

Tyler: Yes. A lot of gas lighting.

Jessica: Tell us the depths of the gas lighting 'cause this is actually what I'm almost most intrigued by by the story is the level of gas lighting and people not being able to say, whoa, the Emperor has no clothes here. What's going on?

Tyler: Yeah. It's a tough question to answer. If you talk to someone who's been gaslit, it can sometimes be really hard to describe the ways that it has happened. But she just created this alternate reality that it seemed like everyone was living in, and she was able to do this in a number of different ways. So she surrounded herself with very credible people and allowed all those credible people to point to someone else as the person who really knew what was going on. Unfortunately, my grandfather was one of those key people where a lot of people pointed to him and said, George Schultz knows what he's doing. He's made a lot of good decisions in his life. I'm going to trust that he's made a good judgment call here and follow him into this. And that's kind of how she put the whole board together.

But then within the company, the way it happened was she basically built this culture of fear over the course of 10 years. And I think in a really important lesson, I know a lot of your audience are founders. Obviously, I think a good lesson here is that culture does not happen by accident, and it does not happen overnight. And for Theranos, this happened over the course of a decade. They intentionally built a culture of fear over the course of 11 years where anytime someone disagreed or questioned Elizabeth, they were fired. And in some cases, after they were fired, they were sued. And when they were sued, they sent out company-wide emails about it that basically said, if you read the subtext, it said, we will sue you too if you get in our way, we will destroy your life if you try to come up against us. And when people see that feedback loop, they stop speaking up.

And by the time people like Erika and I get there, you're all of a sudden dropped into a culture where everybody sees all these red flags. I'd say when I was there, every single person essentially knew that this was a fraud. Everyone who worked with that device knew that it could not test 300 things in a single drop of blood and knew that it was not giving accurate results, but nobody was willing to speak up because we had seen this feedback loop so many times. And what people would do is they would quit. And sometimes people were even too afraid to quit. And I remember I had one very close coworker who when he quit, he actually bought a house in another state, came in on a Friday, put in a full day's work, left his badge on his desk, walked out the door, and by

Monday he was in another state and just never came back. He was just too afraid to even give notice.

Jessica: Oh my God, I cannot believe that story.

Carolynn: I can't either.

Jessica: He bought a house in a different state and was literally afraid to leave the company, like they would chase him.

Tyler: He was afraid to leave the company.

Carolynn: I was just going to say, at the time, obviously people were quitting a lot, there were other jobs that had, this was not a bad economic period for the US, so there must've been lots of other jobs people with this kind of expertise and talent could go do. So the fact that they put up with this paranoid, horrible environment for this long is astonishing.

Tyler: It's a hard phenomenon to describe because I think people will naturally think, well, they had stock options, right?

Carolynn: Yes.

Tyler: But the employees did not. Theranos was a rare startup that almost gave no stock options to anybody.

Carolynn: Oh, I didn't-

Jessica: Another red flag.

Carolynn: Wait, so what was the rationale? Why? Because everyone else was doing it around them.

Tyler: Yeah, so I think the rationale for a lot of people was people had mortgages, they had spouses, they had student debt, they had children, they had visas that were dependent on working at the company. So I think there were a lot of rationalizations to stay. And I think there were a lot of people who were able to make those rational rationalizations and basically say, I'm not the person making these decisions. I'm coming in and I'm doing what I'm told. I'm doing my job. And they kind of felt like their hands were relatively clean because they weren't the ones making the call. They were just executing. But also a lot of people just did not stay very long. People would come and they would do that for a while. Some people would come in and feel like, I can activate change in this organization and try and fail and leave. And it truly was a revolving door. I wish there was a way to actually count how many total employees went through that company.

Carolynn: Did you ever talk to your friends who didn't work at Theranos? So I know you didn't talk about work with your coworkers, you said, but did you ever, friends you went to school with and you were comparing job experiences, and were you like, God, what-

Jessica: He couldn't, Carolynn, right?

Carolynn: So you never even talked to your friends outside of Theranos about it?

Tyler: Well, at some point I did start talking about it because I wanted a sanity check. And so, I did that both within the company and outside the company. Within the company, I would talk to my colleagues and even my managers who I trusted and basically say like, "Am I the crazy one here?" Everyone said, "No, you're not crazy. This technology doesn't work. It's not going to work." And then I would talk to my friends, like you said, about their work experiences. And at the time I lived in the house with five people and I would come home and I would complain about my job. And to be honest, no one really took me that seriously. Everyone would kind of say, yeah, everyone hates their first job. It's just like part of career development is hating your first job. And I would say, "I really think this is different." It could be partly that I wasn't sharing enough details, but a lot of my complaints I think fell on mostly deaf ears within my circle of friends.

Jessica: But you really were prohibited from sharing details about your job more than anyone I've ever heard of from what I've read about this.

Tyler: Yes, absolutely. I mean, my grandfather was on the board, and I wouldn't tell him about the details of my job because I felt like I was not allowed to tell a board member about what my job was. When I reached out to regulators, I felt like I have to get a fake email and a fake name and still reach out to this regulator anonymously because I felt like my NDAs and how seriously they took secrecy prevented me from talking to government regulators.

And even the first time that I ever called a lawyer, I hung up before they answered because I felt like I was not allowed to talk to a lawyer. And this again comes back to being, at that time I was probably 23 years old and just not having enough life experience to realize how much you should be able to trust your lawyer. I'd never worked with a lawyer in my life. Maybe I had a family friend that was a lawyer or something like that, but I never really understood the role of a lawyer. And so I was too afraid. And that was not just the NDAs, it was the culture of bullying and all that.

Carolynn: Were you talking to your parents about it though?

Tyler: I was talking to my parents, I probably shared with them a lot more than I shared with my friends, and my parents always believed me. That was one nice thing. They always believed me and they just wanted me to get out of the situation safely, really. So their advice to me was, "You should just quietly leave. Maintain your relationship with Elizabeth, tell her that you've just decided that you really want to do a PhD, and that will help your career, and just quietly leave." I obviously did not do that.

Jessica: Okay. Let's go back to the story though, because there's so many important points that lead up to that. When you emailed, is it the New York State-

Tyler: Department of Health?

Jessica: ... Department of Health. So there were some major red flags. There were two specifically that you wanted to address with Elizabeth, right?

Tyler: Yeah. There were many that I wanted to address with Elizabeth. But just, so to quickly go through the red flags. So it was just like, one was the Theranos device could not test for more than one thing at a time. So even if it works, you're still limited to testing one thing at a time. It was not a standalone device. So if you put this in a Medevac helicopter, you would also need to put this fancy pipetting robot up in the helicopter with it. It's just totally impractical. It could not, we did not have 300 tests validated. By the time I left we had seven tests that were validated, so we're not even coming close to what Elizabeth is saying.

Then when regulators actually came in to give us our certification to be a central lab, so to get our CLIA certification, the door to Normandy was locked, and we were told not to go in or out of that room that day. And that was so that the regulators wouldn't see activity in that room, they wouldn't go in there and start asking questions and actually see Theranos proprietary equipment. They were only shown the lab that was called Jurassic Park, that had the Siemens and Roche equipment. And at the time, by the way, the board was being told that the only reason they had that equipment was for validation and that every single test was being run on the Theranos device. And Theranos even had shell corporations purchase the third party equipment to hide the fact that they were doing so much of this testing on third party equipment. I didn't know that at the time, but I did eventually learn that.

And then some more red flags were that there were times when we conducted this, essentially an audit with the New York State Department of Health, and in my opinion, we cheated on that audit. We ran tests both on the Theranos device and on third party equipment, but only reported the results from the third party equipment to the auditors, even though in some cases the results were different by more than 300%. So the results are wildly different, and I realize that when management knows they're being watched, they know that they cannot give the result of a Theranos test because the regulator will know that the answer is wrong. But if it was an unsuspecting patient who walked into Walgreens, they were perfectly comfortable knowingly giving them incorrect medical information. So that was a huge, huge red flag.

Another instance of that is when quality controls failed in the lab, and Sunny wood pressure employees to run patient samples despite the quality control failures. And that is, again, a clear indication that, "You know this test isn't working because the quality control failed, but we don't care. We're going to charge the patient \$10 and give them incorrect medical information." And so the red flags were just piling up.

Jessica: When you explain that to us, it seems so clear that this is not working and something needs to change. I just want to throw that in there. It just seems so clearly wrong.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Tyler: Yes. And this is why I felt like I was living in the Twilight Zone, and this is part of the gas lighting. Because you're like, "Everyone has to be seeing this, right?" And you talk to people and you learn that everybody is seeing it, and they're just too afraid to say anything about it. And it still to me feels like the Twilight Zone. It's so obvious. And it's funny because I often talk about this for ethics symposiums and things like that. And to me, it's not even an ethics question, to me ethics is when you have competing values and you have to decide which value is going to win out.

Carolynn: Exactly. Yes.

Tyler: This was like, "It's not an ethical question. It's clear right versus wrong."

Carolynn: Yeah, exactly.

Jessica: Exactly. Yeah.

Tyler: And then for me, a lot of these problems came to a head when we validated syphilis, and the syphilis test clearly was not working. We tested patients that were known to be positive for syphilis, and we only got like 65% correct. So we had 65% sensitivity. We essentially deleted that data and tried again. The next time we got 80% sensitivity. And then we tested samples that were assumed to be negative for syphilis. And for that test, we would test ourselves and test our colleagues. And over 20% of us tested positive for syphilis, which is absolutely insane because for a diagnostic test, typically you can tune it so that you can have really high sensitivity and low specificity, or really high specificity and low sensitivity. And in this case, we were getting very low sensitivity and very low specificity, which just means your test doesn't work.

Jessica: And this is a sexually transmitted disease.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Tyler: Yes, highly communicable. And syphilis is really scary because your symptoms can disappear while you still have it, and it can re-emerge decades later and cause serious, serious health problems. And so it was clear to me that this test didn't work. But we finished the validation study and the medical doctor signed off on it and said, "This is safe and effective, and we're going to start testing real patients for syphilis." And when I got that news, I literally felt like I had gotten punched in the stomach. I felt sick to my stomach, I thought I might throw up. But most of my lab mates kind of celebrated because they didn't have to repeat all of these validation experiments.

And that's when I felt like I really have to start raising my concerns. So that's when I started reaching out to the New York State Department of Health. I started talking to my

colleagues more, to my managers, eventually a vice president, the president and COO, the CEO, a board member. And at every single turn, I was either ignored, gaslit, bullied, and threatened.

Jessica: Wow. It's amazing. So, didn't you email this concern? You tried to talk in person to Elizabeth, and didn't she say, "Oh, just email it to me." Right? And you had confirmed, this is important to the story, had you not confirmed with the New York Health Department, State Health Department that yes, indeed, this was illegal the way they did this?

Tyler: Yeah. So again, I'm not a lawyer, but I went and actually read the laws that governed central laboratories, and I felt like we broke the law. And I actually briefly spoke to the vice president about this, and he brushed me off, and kind of said... He was more concerned about the fact that I knew that they had cheated on it, and was asking me, had I seen the data or just heard about it? Who did you hear it from? Who else has seen this? Who else has heard it?

Carolynn: Oh, wow.

Tyler: And he kind of did acknowledge actually that they did not do that audit correctly, but he did not seem to think it was a big issue at all. And that's when I felt like, "I'm going to reach out to a regulator who actually conducted this test and ask them directly if what we did was okay." And their response was very clear. They said, "No, this is a clear violation of our regulations."

And when I first reached out, I didn't even say that I worked at Theranos. I just vaguely described the situation and they said, "Can you please let us know the name of the company you worked for? What tests were run? The dates those tests were run?" So I put together all that information. I ended up going through, what they call the Laboratory Investigative Unit, which is where my alias could be anonymous. And then I never heard back from them, which was very disappointing.

Later, the Wall Street Journal reporter did follow up and said, "What happened to this complaint?" And it sounds like they had determined that this was not a New York State issue, this was a federal issue. So they forwarded it to the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services, which governs labs federally. And it just sounds like somehow it got lost in the shuffle.

Jessica: Lost in the shuffle.

Carolynn: Lost in the shuffle. That's so surprising.

Jessica: So you take this information though, I mean you gently approach Elizabeth with your concerns.

Tyler: Yes. Sorry, that was-

Jessica: Gently, right?

Tyler: So first I gently approached them in person. I did not push very hard at all. I just said, "Here's two concerns that I have." And after that, Elizabeth set me up with these conversations with the vice president. But after I was not satisfied by the vice president, I felt like I need to have another conversation with Elizabeth to make sure that my concerns are heard and that they're addressed. At that point, she started ignoring me.

Not ignoring me, really, she was putting me off. She would say, "I'm too busy to meet with you." Which was very unusual for her, because like I said, by that time, she was becoming part of my family. And I even offered to meet with her late at night because I worked the night shift and she worked very late. And I said, "I could meet you after regular business hours, after the craziness of the day has died down." And she just said she was too busy, and that I should put all my concerns in an email and she would address them.

And that turned out to be an absolutely wonderful thing, because not all of my concerns, but a lot of my concerns were clearly documented in this email at the time. And what I did was, I just would lay out, "This is an observation that I've made. Here's data that I've collected to support that observation, and this is what I think we should do about it." Because I didn't want to approach her and say, "This is a total fraud. This is never going to work." I wanted to come to her from the perspective of, "I am a team member to you. We are working on this together. I want to find solutions." And in fact, I even concluded that email by saying, "I apologize if this sounds attacking in any way. It is truly not meant to be. I'm dedicated to the long-term vision of this company, but I'm worried that some of our current practices are going to prevent us from reaching our long-term goals." I wanted to make it clear, "I'm on your team here."

And she did not provide much of a response to that email, but she forwarded it to Sunny, who again was the president, COO, board member, investor, and boyfriend. And his reply was longer than mine. It was in all red, a lot of it all capitalized, a lot of it all bolded. And he essentially said that I was arrogant, ignorant, patronizing, reckless. I had no understanding of basic math, science, or statistics, and that if I had any other last name, that I would've already been held accountable in the strongest way.

Carolynn: Oh, shit.

Jessica: Blistering attack.

Carolynn: Wow.

Tyler: Yes.

Carolynn: Well, here's... It's a little weird that Elizabeth said, "Put it in an email." She's super paranoid, but she wants all this in writing? That's a weird contradiction.

Tyler: Yeah, I think she looks back on that and probably thinks-

Carolynn: Regrets it a lot.

Tyler: ... "That was a really big mistake."

Carolynn: Yeah. No kidding. It's weird... When you've been running a paranoid shop for 11 years at that point, that's a weird little misstep by her.

Jessica: It is a weird misstep, isn't it Carolynn? Very odd.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Jessica: But this is a pivotal point though, Tyler. You get the blistering attack from Sunny.

Tyler: So as part of that blistering email, he gave me an M&M analogy. Because part of my discussions with the vice president got, I would say, way too into the weeds, to the point where we were arguing about how to calculate an average. The details of that discussion don't really matter. But as part of Sunny's blistering email, he said, "How are you so dumb that you don't understand what we're doing here? It's like we're trying to count M&M's, and instead of having one person count them, we have six people count them, and then we take an average." He thought that's the thing that I didn't understand. So in my initial response, I was so angered by his patronizing tone back to me, that my initial draft of my resignation email was, "I understand how to count M&M's. My point is that I would rather have one adult count the M and M's than six four year olds."

Carolynn: Savage.

Jessica: Oh, my God.

Tyler: Which is really the crux of the argument that I was having with the vice president earlier.

Carolynn: Wow.

Jessica: Wow.

Tyler: It's like, "I don't care what statistical methods you can apply. If the data is this terrible, the results are just going to be terrible." But ultimately, I thought that that was not going to be very productive. So I deleted it. I'd typed it out, gotten it out of my system, deleted it. And I just wrote, "Consider this my two weeks notice. If you prefer I leave earlier, that's fine with me as well."

Carolynn: Giving two weeks in that circumstance is very generous.

Jessica: He's an upstanding guy.

Carolynn: Yeah. Yeah, yeah, yeah.

Tyler: I was trying to not ruffle feathers as much as I possibly could, even though I was obviously ruffling feathers.

Carolynn: And just to clarify, you had not spoken to your grandfather at this point, right?

Tyler: So actually I had spoken to him. I actually brought a lot of data and analysis to his house and went through it with him, and it was clear that he didn't really understand what I was talking about. A good example is I showed him a plot of our vitamin D validation, where there's a line that goes horizontally through the graph that shows the correct result. It's 10 nanograms per milliliter, or whatever it is. And then there is the plot of every time we tested that sample on top of the line. And if you have a good test, it's right on the line. Our test just looked like a total hodgepodge of throw darts at a wall. And he looked at it and said, "Well, it looks like most of those dots are way above the line, so that looks pretty good to me." And I tried to describe to him what these graphs were supposed to mean, and he clearly did not understand. And his response was just, "You need to go sort out these questions with Elizabeth."

Carolynn: Did you ever say to him, "Okay, forget the science for a minute, it's a really weird environment there. There's locked doors, there's paranoia, there's churn." Did you ever talk to him about the big picture stuff?

Tyler: Yeah, I did. And he already knew that. He knew that I wasn't sharing details about what my job was with him, even though he was a board member. And he would almost use that as, almost like a joke in a positive way. He was like, "Oh, Theranos is so secretive and takes their trade secrets so seriously, that my own grandson won't tell me about what he's working on. It's like he's working at the CIA." And it just became this almost like a fun bit. So he knew, but he did view it as a positive, and he had bought into the same excuses that Elizabeth had originally sold me on.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Jessica: He just was, I want to say he was kind of brainwashed at this point.

Tyler: Totally. And that actually goes back to the whole gas lighting thing that we had talked about. I can't remember which documentary it was, but my wife and I watched a documentary about a cult. And I remember listening to one of the interviews and my eyes kind of popped, and I thought, "Theranos employees could have said that exact same thing."

Carolynn: Weird.

Tyler: She had built this cult-like following, and my grandfather was certainly drinking the Kool-Aid.

Carolynn: When she would show up for family events at your house, were you like, "Oh, cool, Elizabeth's here, we can chat about stuff." Or was it like, "Ugh, she's the..." How did that dynamic play out in your house?

Tyler: Yeah. So usually, to be super clear, it was not at my house. It was at my grandfather's house.

Carolynn: Grandparent's house, sorry. Yeah, yeah, yeah.

Tyler: But that is a house that I've been going to for my entire life, grew up 20 minutes away. So it did feel like a second home in a lot of ways. And at the beginning it was very exciting. It was like if you had Steve Jobs coming over to your house for intimate family dinners. It felt amazing. And Elizabeth always wanted me to sit next to her. And I just felt like, I felt so good, and I felt like I had this growing connection with Elizabeth, and the rest of my family fell for her as well. We thought this was the greatest thing. We also learned that my grandfather had set up a trust fund for his great-grandchildren. So my children who at the time did not exist, that consisted 100% of Theranos stock.

Carolynn: Oh, my word.

Tyler: Exclusively Theranos stock, like all in.

Carolynn: Which, by the way, since you didn't get any stock options, that would've been the only Theranos stock you would have had, right?

Tyler: Correct.

Carolynn: Okay.

Jessica: And was this a large part of his total net worth, would you say?

Tyler: I, even to this day, do not have a very clear window into his finances. I know that he was a wealthy person, but he was not like Silicon Valley type wealthy. He made most of his money as the CEO of Bechtel Corporation, probably in the '80s or something like that.

Jessica: Oh, yeah. Okay.

Tyler: And I have done back of the envelope calculations where he had, I forget exactly how much stock he had, but at the peak valuation of \$75 a share, his stock options were worth over \$200 million.

Jessica: Wow. Okay.

Tyler: And so he was a wealthy person, but he was not that wealthy. That could have been, for all I know, that could have been 90% of his net worth. That's kind of where I would estimate it to be, but I don't truly know. But it was a lot. It was a blinding, absolutely blinding amount of money. And I think Elizabeth was hoping that it would also be blinding to me. She knew that my children would have a trust fund that consisted of 100% Theranos stock, and she knew exactly how much stock was in there. So I'm sure she thought, like any other normal person, "Tyler's going to be blinded by the amount of money that this could be for his children one day."

Jessica: Right. I did not know this. That's fascinating. Your heirs would've benefited from Theranos succeeding. That adds a whole new layer to this.

Carolynn: And obviously your grandfather told you all this, so you were supposed to know, like this wasn't a secret. This is supposed to actually-

Tyler: It was not a secret.

Carolynn: Yeah. Okay.

Tyler: My entire family knew. Elizabeth knew. Sunny knew.

Carolynn: Yeah, of course.

Tyler: And we're skipping, I could skip ahead a little bit here. But when I would try to talk sense into my grandfather, he flat out would not believe me. The only thing he really would believe is I would say, "I know that we have an enormous amount of money sitting in a trust fund for my children. Why on earth would I want that to go to zero? I want that to be worth something, I do. But I don't want it to be an excuse for aiding and abetting a fraud. I want it to be worth something. I want this to happen. I have no motivation to bring this company down. I would be so happy to be wrong." I would've been the happiest person in the world if somehow I was proven wrong.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Jessica: Actually, can you say something that I had heard in a podcast earlier where you said, basically when you were asking some of those initial questions of Elizabeth, you weren't trying to take her down. In fact, you would've been delighted if she had answers for them, right?

Tyler: Absolutely. The entire time I was hoping that they would have answers. When I first started and I saw the initial red flags, I felt like, "There must be some locked door somewhere, where the technology really is." And I was holding out hope that there was something. And then when I was asking my colleagues, "Are you seeing the same things that I'm seeing?" I was hoping someone could prove me wrong. And that's actually a step that I did really well in my own whistleblower journey, that I recommend everyone do, is try as hard as you possibly can to prove yourself wrong.

And that was so important for me because, first of all, I think I did that step really well. Having spoken to all the people I spoke to, plus regulators, I tried really hard to prove myself wrong. And once I couldn't, I had absolute 100% conviction in myself and in my beliefs, that the truth was on my side, that the facts were on my side. And I just knew no matter what the truth was on my side, the data was on my side. And I could always feel comforted by that. And that was hugely important to me, as a very data-driven person, I think.

Jessica: As a scientist.

Tyler: As a scientist, yes.

Jessica: Yeah.

Carolynn: We got a little sidetracked, but I want to go back just to the question I had was at what point would you go over to your grandfather's house and you're like, "Oh, man, Elizabeth is here. I don't really want to see her."

Tyler: Yes. Wow. We got so far.

Carolynn: Yeah, because I really was actually super curious about that specific question. So you were saying at first it was great because she wanted to sit with you, and everyone was so into her. When did that start to change?

Tyler: So, that started to change once I started working there full time.

Carolynn: Okay.

Tyler: So, once I started working there, she had been to two Christmases, and then that December was the first Christmas that we shared together where I had actually worked at the company and seen behind the curtains. And the things she was saying to my family at that Christmas just drove me insane. Once you can see through the lies and see through the manipulation, it became so painful and frankly, just a lot harder to even continue staying quiet, which at the time I was staying quiet.

Carolynn: Right.

Tyler: She would say things like, "Tyler is doing better work than the PhDs that I've hired. Tyler is showing so much leadership potential." She was saying all the right things to the right people to make me feel good, to make me feel like I had a future at the company, to make me feel like there was big upside financially for me at the company. But I could see straight through it by that time. I was like, "I know what you're doing. I'm not doing better work than the PhDs you've hired. I can recognize that. I'm not the smartest person at this company. As much as I want to maybe believe that, I know that I'm not, and I know you're just saying these things."

My family did start questioning a little bit the speed at which the Theranos technology was being rolled out, because this was year three that we were hearing about it, and it always had sounded like Theranos was on the brink of this huge nationwide rollout. And I do remember, I have an uncle who asked, "Why aren't you up in Portland yet? We've been talking about this for three years now. Where is it?"

And she always had some kind of an excuse. One of those excuses was that she was going above and beyond what was required of them by the regulatory agencies. So, because they were utilizing this laboratory developed pathway, they actually did not need to submit any data to the FDA. But Elizabeth would say that it was very important to them as a company and to their values as a company to be evaluated by the FDA. And

she would say that they've submitted thousands of pages of documentation to the FDA in pre-submissions, and that the FDA was slow. She would always have these excuses, when in reality, I think people who have been in this business realize that submitting data in a pre-submission is not nearly the type of traction or engagement with the FDA that Elizabeth was making it out to be. She was making it sound like a big deal that they had this pre-submission with the FDA, when I could schedule a pre-submission with the FDA right now based on an idea that you and I come up with on this podcast.

Carolynn: Right, right. Wow.

Tyler: So she would always have an excuse.

Carolynn: Oh no.

Tyler: And then I remember after that lunch or dinner or whatever it was and she was away, some of my aunts and uncles were around, and they said, "Wow, you're so lucky to be working at a great company like Theranos. This is just so amazing. What an opportunity for you." And I just shook my head and said, "That place is a complete disaster. Nothing works."

Carolynn: Oh, wow!

Tyler: "This is never going to happen." And I was pretty open with them. I just couldn't hold it in after seeing her just continually lying to my family. And I could see it in real time her trying to gaslight me, and I just couldn't hold it in. I was like, "No, this is a complete fraud, basically."

Carolynn: Did you-

Tyler: I probably didn't use that word, but I said, "This is not working. The reason we're not rolling out is because it doesn't work. It's not because we're waiting for the FDA."

Jessica: What did they say? How was their response?

Tyler: It was actually mixed. Some people said, "You should quietly leave. It's not really your place to raise this with your grandfather. You should let the company take its natural course of action." And then I got other advice that was, "No, you should absolutely not do that. Why not talk to your grandfather? Maybe you should try to do more."

Jessica: Yeah.

Tyler: Yeah, so it became painful at some point that she was coming, and it became more painful a little bit further on in the story.

Carolynn: Did you ever reach out to past employees or meet past employees? What's ringing in my head is one of the original board members who was from Apple, Avie, and he actually had some questions and felt like, as a board member, it was his responsibility to ask

some of these questions, and he basically got canned. Did you ever meet people like that, that you're like, "No way. That's what I've been thinking"?

Tyler: Unfortunately not. I didn't know who had really worked there before. The company's history is all public now, but it wasn't super public back then. I would have never known that Avie was on the board. And I feel like we just didn't talk enough to know about who had been there, who had worked there before. I wouldn't have even known to reach out to. And to even illustrate that point even more, the chief scientist of Theranos took his own life. He did that between when I was an intern and when I worked there full time. So I was kind of there around the time that that happened, and I never knew about it. I never heard about it.

Carolynn: Oh, wow!

Tyler: I never heard his name until later, the Wall Street Journal reporter, when I was talking to him, he told me the story.

Carolynn: Oh, wow!

Tyler: I did not know it until I learned about it much longer after the fact.

Jessica: That is so sad.

Tyler: So if I didn't know that was happening-

Carolynn: Yeah, I was just going to say-

Tyler: ... I certainly didn't know that Avie Tavanian was a board member five years ago.

Jessica: Right, right.

Carolynn: In hindsight, it's all been laid out by Bad Blood and all the articles and stuff like that. But I guess back then, they did a really good job of keeping everything under wraps.

Jessica: Yeah.

Tyler: Yeah. And it would've been so discouraged for a former employee to talk to a current employee. I don't think anyone would've taken that risk.

Jessica: Yeah.

Carolynn: Okay.

Tyler: Even if I'd reached out to Avie, for instance. I don't know him, but-

Carolynn: Let's go a little bit deeper into your pre-leaving with a few questions. I have a few questions about her, Elizabeth. I'm going to cut right to the chase. Did you know she had a fake voice? Was that a thing amongst the employees that she had changed her voice?

Tyler: It's funny, but I don't ever remember someone accusing her of that while I worked there. But there were times when I felt like when she was laughing at something, maybe she would lose control of her voice a little bit, and it would slip, and it would jump up an octave. But for the most part, she was very, very good at maintaining that low octave every time I spoke to her. I don't know for sure that it was faked, but from people who knew her in college and even in the early days of Theranos say that there was a stark difference in her voice from when she started the company to when it was at its peak.

Jessica: You said in a podcast that she was a master of planting seeds for lies that she would need years from now. Can you give us an example of that?

Tyler: Yes. That is, again, another part of the gaslighting. And on the gaslighting theme, it just happened in so many different directions, and you were surrounded by it all the time that you... And that's what gaslighting is. You almost don't notice that it's happening because it is just constant, and it just becomes the reality. And part of that was she was a genius, an absolute genius at planting lies literally years before she would need to use them. And a really good example of that is the first time I ever met Elizabeth in my grandfather's living room, she said that they were going to remain a private company forever because of all of the benefits that come with not being a public company. And she knew that they would never be able to IPO.

Carolynn: Right.

Tyler: There's way too much scrutiny, way too many things that need to become transparent when you IPO, when you're a public company. She knew that was simply not an option for Theranos. So rather than get... She raised almost a billion dollars in funding. So rather than raise a billion dollars in funding, have the value skyrocket, and then suddenly have all these investors clamoring for an IPO event, she got ahead of that conversation and before they even invested would say, "We are never going to IPO. We will be private forever." And she got ahead of that conversation so that it would never happen. And it's absolutely genius.

Carolynn: What was the selling point then? Dividends? Why would investors want that product?

Tyler: I have no idea. Private market. Sell it on a private market.

Carolynn: Yeah, I guess secondaries, but like... Yeah. Okay.

Jessica: Let's talk about some of those investors, because actually the investor thing is a whole interesting side story. Carolynn and I are obviously with Y Combinator, so we know a lot of investors. I didn't know any of their investors. I mean, well, you know of them, but there were no mainstream venture capitalists really, except, I guess, Tim Draper was an early investor, but...

Tyler: Yeah, so Tim Draper would be the exception, but he was really like an angel investor. They put in \$500,000. It was, I think, the first check or one of the first checks. So I almost don't really count that as a true VC investment. It was truly an angel investment from Tim Draper, not truly from the fund.

Jessica: Yeah.

Tyler: To your point, I actually think that Silicon Valley VCs don't get enough credit for not getting sucked into the hype of Theranos.

Carolynn: That's a great point.

Jessica: Let's compliment them, Carolynn. VCs were very, very clever on this one.

Tyler: They were.

Carolynn: You know, for real.

Tyler: Silicon Valley VCs rarely get compliments.

Jessica: Yeah, they do not get-

Tyler: But I genuinely think they are due a compliment here.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Jessica: Yeah.

Carolynn: I think that's right.

Tyler: I have spoken to some very powerful Silicon Valley VCs. I don't think he would mind that I share his name because it actually makes him look good. But for instance, I spoke to Vinod Khosla of Khosla Ventures, and he basically says that, of course, Theranos pitched Khosla. And he went and visited the company, and Khosla had a process. They ran the process. The process said, don't invest, and they didn't. And I hear very similar things from partners at Sequoia and Google Ventures. And over and over, now I hear people say they passed on Theranos, and it was people who had processes, people who had teams. People who were not sole decision-makers did discover that this was not a good investment. And if you stuck to your process, you did not invest.

Carolynn: Did Vinod actually say like, "It was because we had this checklist of questions, and we got stonewalled on all of them, or we could tell they were lies"? Sorry, this is a weird thing to drill down into, but I'm just curious. Why didn't he get sold on her whole thing?

Tyler: He didn't provide a whole lot of specifics into exactly what the process was, but the gist of the conversation was, "We had a process, and we ran it, and it was clear that this was not going to be a good fit for Khosla."

Carolynn: Okay, okay.

Tyler: And they didn't get caught up in the hype.

Carolynn: Yeah, yeah.

Jessica: Which is hard to do based on how you describe her.

Tyler: It is. Yeah. And in fact, some of these people would even say that after they passed and Theranos just went up like a rocket ship, they thought, "What did I miss? How do I need to change my process so that I don't pass on the next Theranos?"

Jessica: I think there were a lot of people who had serious concerns. Like, "Did I miss out?" They were questioning things. I'd like to take a quick second, and sorry to interrupt your story, Tyler, because yours is the one we're focused on. But I do think it's interesting to give Carolynn and my perspective, also being in the investment community. I have never met Elizabeth, and I don't think you did either, Carolynn.

Carolynn: No, I did not.

Jessica: And actually, I don't know many people who did, but we'd see her on the cover of magazines. And Carolynn and I have done a lot of work over the years promoting women in the industry and encouraging female founders. We launched a Female Founders Conference in 2014 that I'm certain one of those years we invited Elizabeth to speak. I mean, she was-

Carolynn: Right, right.

Jessica: The one thing I remember in my mind was like, "Thank God this woman is succeeding. This is so great. We have this role model for more women to do this." And I was thrilled because she was the hottest ticket in town.

Carolynn: Yeah.

Tyler: The world, especially Silicon Valley, but the world was craving a female Steve Jobs.

Carolynn: Mm-hmm.

Jessica: Yeah.

Tyler: And Elizabeth just served herself up on a platter. This was a story everyone wanted to believe. She said all the right things at the right time, and everyone just wanted it to be true so badly, including myself.

Jessica: Tyler, you've answered my question I have. To what extent did she manipulate the press's desire for female founders? And I said they did not want to look closely inside the box because it's like their ideology and the reality was so... The difference between it

was so big. They wanted a female founder to succeed, so they didn't ask hard questions either until John Carreyrou came along.

Tyler: Yeah, I absolutely agree with that. And it is just such a shame because not only was she the female Steve Jobs, she was the female founder. She just made such a big deal out of it. She made such a big deal about being the youngest self-made female billionaire, and she had these quotes, that there's a special place in hell for women who don't help other women. And she just unfortunately became the poster child for the female founder, and it ended up being obviously a complete sham. But I just wish she would have just done it and not called so much attention to it, because now I think female founders are actually hurt more now because of how much attention she brought to herself for being a woman.

Carolynn: I was just thinking that, and I don't know if this timeline is correct, but there's just been a lot of female founders who have gotten a lot of crap since then for-

Jessica: They're targeted a little bit.

Carolynn: They're targeted, legitimately or no. But I was just thinking she may be the reason female founders... actually, the high profile ones, just end up going through the wringer harder than your average male founder does.

Jessica: Yeah.

Carolynn: There's a bunch of examples, like The Wing and all those people.

Tyler: She certainly didn't help, and I think she's probably part of the problem, but she's certainly not the entire problem.

Carolynn: No.

Tyler: But I think the other really sad piece about this is that she showed that the formula to becoming the female Steve Jobs or the youngest self-made female billionaire is to get these old white men to just fall in love with you and throw money at you. And she used her femininity in order to do that. She could not achieve what she was able to achieve had she been a man.

Carolynn: That's an unfortunate trope to lean into.

Jessica: Wow!

Tyler: And it's sad that that was the formula. That is what worked.

Carolynn: Do you not think that a male could be just as charismatic and get away with the lies, or do you really think it was the way she looked and the fact that she was a woman?

Tyler: I think it is possible for a man to commit massive frauds. Let's look at Sam Bankman-Fried.

Jessica: SBF. Yeah.

Tyler: SBF. But he did it in a very different way. The way that Elizabeth went about it is she relied on her being a woman to commit this fraud and to raise that much money. If Sunny was raising this \$700 million mega round, he would've fallen on his face. It would not have gotten any traction.

Carolynn: You know what's funny, though, when you describe her, the person who keeps popping into my head is Bill Clinton, because I've heard Bill Clinton described very similarly in terms of making you feel like you're the only person in the room.

Jessica: He is. I've met him.

Carolynn: Yeah. So I think absolutely. I think the targets would be different. I think that's what you're saying. She was able to target a very specific type of investor because of what she was doing. And men who are like her would have a different type of target, but be just as effective.

Tyler: Right, right. And then the other part that I think is really unfortunate is not only did she really highlight the fact she was a woman on the way up, but she also tried to use it as an excuse on the way down.

Carolynn: Famously.

Tyler: And I think that was frustrating to me. I imagine it was even more frustrating to female founders who were saying, "Do not use the fact that you are a woman as an excuse right now."

Carolynn: For massive, massive fraud.

Jessica: Yeah.

Tyler: Yeah. That doesn't help us.

Carolynn: She set us back.

Tyler: Yeah. She was so public about saying that it was a witch hunt and that they were coming after her because she was a woman. And then even at her trial, she made it so public that she had just had a baby and then a second baby, and just made a big show out of the fact that she was a new mother. She completely changed her personality, her persona, to becoming like, "I'm this mother. Please help me. I've done nothing wrong."

Jessica: Do you think she had kids to manipulate the sentencing?

Tyler: It's hard to say definitively. I do think that. I think that when I knew Elizabeth, she said she would never have a boyfriend, never get married, and never have kids because she was just so devoted to the vision of Theranos, and Theranos was her child. Theranos was her husband. The board... Like, Henry Kissinger described her as being part of the monastic order because of how devoted she was to Theranos. So when it was inconvenient for her to have children, she had absolutely no desire to have children. And then when suddenly it becomes this very convenient thing for her, she then decides, this is the best thing for me in this moment to have kids. It was not the best time in her life for the kids, for sure. It was the best time in Elizabeth's life for her to have kids.

Jessica: Yeah, totally.

Tyler: And what illustrates this even more is that around the time of the sentencing, she did this... I don't even know exactly what it was, but an op-ed with the New York Times where a reporter went and spent a lot of time with her. And she had photos of her kids in the article. And typically, when you have things like this, you have people shield their kids from this type of news attention. And to me, I just felt so bad for those kids, genuinely so bad for those kids, because when I knew her, her black turtleneck was her prop. She loved having these props to tell stories and to get people to focus on one thing when they should be focused on something else. And to me, it seems like she's now using her kids like she used to use the black turtleneck.

Carolynn: Oof. Would you call her a sociopath? Just as an armchair psychologist, do you think that's what we're dealing with here, is sociopathy?

Tyler: I think there's some pathology about her. I don't know exactly what it is, but something like a sociopath, psychopath. She has a way to rationalize decisions that I think people like you and I simply would not be able to rationalize.

Carolynn: Right.

Jessica: This is so random, but when she had all the security, famous security, I mean, I think she even had security when she was only at a \$1 million valuation.

Tyler: Yeah.

Jessica: And she was Eagle 1. Was that all for manipulation and show and to make it seem like she was so important? Because I know founders with security, and it just doesn't seem like at the point where she got all the security she actually needed it.

Tyler: Yeah. That was part of the show. No doubt. She was surrounded by security at all times. Every door was opened for her by the security. Every time she walked through the door, it was, "Eagle 1. Eagle 1, da, da, da, da. Eagle 2 on the way, da, da, da." And it's like, why are you using the code name Eagle 1 when she's walking? Everyone knows who you're talking about, right?

Jessica: She had a code name; that's absurd.

Tyler: It is absolutely absurd. And they would also do silly things when they would meet people at restaurants in Palo Alto, where they would try to leave at different times so that if someone was watching them, they wouldn't know that they were meeting with X person. And Elizabeth and Sunny would arrive and leave at different times, which is just so funny when... I forget what the license plate was, but Sunny would be driving out with his Porsche with the vanity license plate that says... I forget what it actually said, but something that clearly calls attention to the fact that he is there.

Jessica: In like a Lamborghini or something, right?

Tyler: Yeah, a Lamborghini. Yeah. Something even flashier than a Porsche, for sure.

Jessica: In Bad Blood, the author talked about one of these meetings, and I think maybe it was with Walgreens or Safeway or something like that, and it was at Fuki Sushi, I think, Carolyn.

Carolynn: Which we've all been to.

Jessica: Which we've all been to.

Carolynn: We've all been there.

Jessica: And the funny thing was, it was 4:30 in the afternoon. That was sort of the kicker. They did all this cloak-and-dagger stuff at 4:30.

Carolynn: No one-

Jessica: No one was in the restaurant.

Carolynn: ... was at Fuki Sushi at 4:30 in the afternoon.

Tyler: On my last day, I get this blistering email. Actually, after I send the email that says, "If you prefer I leave earlier, that's fine with me as well," I assumed that they were going to have me leave that day. So I didn't do any work. I almost felt guilty about it, which retrospectively seems kind of crazy. But I was like, "You know what? I'm going to take the morning off." I was in the break room. I was just chatting with people as they came by. And then at some point, my manager pulled me aside. It was actually... My true manager had just left for maternity leave. So it was someone who kind of stepped in to be my manager, said, "Elizabeth and Sunny actually feel like it's more appropriate if you leave today. So I just want to make sure that your lab notebook is all organized, and whatever experience you were working on we can pass off to somebody else."

So for a couple hours, I just went through my lab notebook. I explained to him exactly what everything meant, what I was planning on doing next, printed out pieces of data that were missing, and glued it into the lab notebook. All that, I would say, very professional. And then eventually, I got an email from the head of HR, and she just said, "Can you come to my office at 3:00?" or something like that. So I go to her office, and

she has this really, I would say, fake pained look on her face, where she's like, "Elizabeth and Sunny really think it's better if you leave today. We're really sorry that things didn't work out." And I was just like, "Get me out of here. I'm so happy to leave."

Jessica: I'm out of here.

Tyler: Yeah. And so she gave me another NDA to sign. I didn't read it; just signed it.

Carolynn: Oh!

Tyler: I shouldn't have.

Carolynn: You're killing me.

Tyler: I wish I hadn't.

Carolynn: You're killing me.

Tyler: Yeah. Yeah.

Carolynn: Okay. So just for the legal aspect here, it was probably a termination certificate that reiterated all the stuff you'd already agreed to and then made it very clear that your obligations were going into the future indefinitely. That's probably what it was.

Tyler: Yes.

Carolynn: Did you get a copy of it, by the way?

Tyler: Yeah. It's actually very, very funny that you bring this up because just by complete, complete coincidence, my wife was just cleaning out a closet and happened to find the folder that I got handed to me by the head of HR. Literally, right before we got on this podcast, she was like, "This is this Theranos folder." And I was like, "Oh, shit!"

Carolynn: You're like, "Oh, hey." Yeah. Okay. So that was in there.

Tyler: Yeah. There's really not much in here. It's literally just that exact letter that you mentioned.

Carolynn: Wow, okay.

Jessica: Oh my God.

Carolynn: Wow.

Tyler: I still haven't read it.

Carolynn: Oh!

Jessica: Yeah.

Carolynn: Maybe keep it that way actually.

Jessica: That's too funny.

Tyler: But I can tell it does say some things: confidentiality, blah, blah, blah, blah, blah.

Carolynn: Yeah, okay.

Tyler: It's also, you can see... It's kind of funny. You can see on every page that you printed out at Theranos has Theranos Confidential written across it.

Carolynn: Stamped all over it? Wow!

Tyler: Yeah. It's funny that you bring that up because I happen to have accidentally just found that exact folder that you mentioned.

Carolynn: That is such a weird coincidence. Okay. So HR is like, "Sign it." And you're like, "No problem. I can't wait to get out of here." Oh, did you forward to yourself or print any emails? Because we talked about "the email" a few minutes ago.

Tyler: Mm-hmm.

Carolynn: How did you have those?

Tyler: Great question. So while I worked at Theranos, I had on a couple occasions emailed things to myself that ended up causing a lot of trouble for me.

Carolynn: Smart. Oh, okay.

Tyler: But unfortunately, they were really unhelpful things to me, but still caused a lot of problems. One was a presentation that I made, kind of like my final presentation as an intern that I wanted to practice at home, and I wasn't allowed to take my laptop out of the building, so I emailed it to myself so I could practice the presentation at home. I then couldn't open the attachment from my personal laptop, so I couldn't do it. But in one of these documents that I signed, I claimed that I had not taken out any confidential information, and they said, "You lied to us. You emailed this presentation to yourself when you were an intern."

Carolynn: And you breached your contract?

Tyler: I guess I did. I broke my contract by sending myself this attachment. Totally, genuinely benign.

Carolynn: Yeah. So you could practice it. It's breaking my heart.

Tyler: I know.

Carolynn: I know.

Tyler: And then I had also forwarded a couple links to papers that I wanted to read at home.

Carolynn: Internal papers or external?

Tyler: No, no, no. Third-party, published papers that I had gone on Google Scholar and found on my personal laptop that I then emailed the link to myself so I could read the paper at home on my personal laptop.

Carolynn: That's super benign.

Tyler: Got busted. Got busted.

Carolynn: Okay. But the email, the big email to Elizabeth with all of your-

Tyler: Yes.

Carolynn: The one that said... That must've been in discovery. That was part of litigation?

Tyler: Yeah.

Carolynn: You didn't actually send that to yourself, did you?

Tyler: That's the big one that I did sneak out.

Carolynn: You did sneak that out.

Tyler: That's the one big thing that I did intentionally sneak out. I was too afraid to email it to myself. Luckily, I didn't do that.

Carolynn: Right.

Tyler: I couldn't bring the laptop out of the building, so I decided to print a copy while I was at Theranos. I hit print and nothing came out. I hit print and nothing came out. I just hit print, print, print. Why is this not working? Then suddenly out of the printer, I'm not kidding you, probably a dozen plus copies of this very, very long email started printing out.

Carolynn: That's so [inaudible 01:12:49].

Tyler: If we're talking-

Carolynn: Were you panicked?

Tyler: I was totally panicked. I was over the copy machine, over the printer, and my computer was probably a solid 25 plus yards away. I was too afraid to just let these continue printing out while I wasn't hovering over them to try to run back to my laptop to stop the print from happening. So I just stood there for, it seemed like an eternity.

Carolynn: I bet.

Tyler: While probably, if I had to estimate, a total of 2 to 300 pages printed out.

Carolynn: Oh my [inaudible 01:13:20]. Was this actually on your last day, or did you do this before your last day? This was like-

Tyler: This was my very last day.

Carolynn: Your very last day. You were about to leave the building, turn in your laptop, leave the building, and this stupid printer, it will not stop printing copies of this.

Jessica: Oh my God.

Carolynn: Inflammatory-

Jessica: On your last day-

Carolynn: I'm tense listening to this.

Jessica: I thought you did this before. This is on your last day. So now your-

Carolynn: This is-

Tyler: It was on the very last day.

Jessica: They're watching you. Oh, my God.

Tyler: I suppose this was the other, I guess, non-benign thing that I did, aside from just sitting around in the break room. I did do this.

Carolynn: Yeah, okay.

Tyler: But it took a long time. I was so nervous that someone was going to come over and be like, what is this ream of paper you're printing out? And I knew that there were cameras everywhere too. On every door in the parking lot. So it stopped printing. I took the ream of paper, I stuck it under my shirt. I think I was actually, I put on a sweatshirt intentionally. Even though I'd never wear sweatshirts, but I put on a sweatshirt, stuck it under my shirt. I had a hand under my shirt, and I walked out the building with this ream of emails under my shirt, and I put it in the trunk of my car.

Jessica: Wow. Can I just make a side note from Bad Blood? It's stuck with me and I laughed out loud. It was like the HR person said, "There'll be a security person to escort you out to your car," and then it was like, "Unfortunately no security person was available, and Tyler saw himself out."

Carolynn: True.

Tyler: It is true. It is a funny detail. But it does matter because they later characterized my last day as me just leaving in an absolute storm. But I mean, to kind of tell that story, so back to this meeting where I got this envelope right here. They said, "Security's going to have to come escort you out of the building." I had, I think one or two personal books on my desk. And so I just said, "Can I just go get my books?" And they said, "No. We're going to mail them to you."

And I was like, "Really? I can't just go grab this book on kinetics?" And she said, "Nope. Security's going to come escort you straight out the building." We sat there for a while. She said, "Well, it looks like security's busy. Can you just walk yourself out?" And I said, "Yeah, sure." And I was like, "Can I go grab my books on the way?" She said, "No, definitely not. Just walk straight out the door." So I left. No one escorted me. I walked out the door. There was someone from security at the front desk. And so I chatted with him for two minutes, very cordial, and walked out the door. And then literally, this is cinematic timing. Before I even got to my car, my mom called me and she said, "Stop, whatever it is you're about to do." And I said, "It's too late. I literally just walked out the door and they are not going to let me back in. I can tell you that much."

Carolynn: Wait, why did your mom call you?

Tyler: Well, yeah, so she said, "I just got off the phone with your grandfather. And he said that Elizabeth just told him that you vocalized a vendetta against her, and that if you try to execute this vendetta that you will lose."

Carolynn: Oh my God.

Jessica: I wonder if... And what did you say to your mom?

Tyler: I said, "I have no idea what she's talking about." And she said, "Okay, well just go talk to your grandfather right now." So I got in my car and I drove to my grandfather's office on the Stanford campus. And he said, "Elizabeth tells me that you quit in a very traumatic and inappropriate way, and that she was trying to meet with you to calm you down, but that you were refusing to meet with her."

Carolynn: Wow.

Jessica: We're in shock. Carolyn and I are in shock.

Carolynn: I am in shock. Wow.

Tyler: Yeah. And I just said, "That cannot be further from the truth. I've been trying to schedule a meeting with her. She's been avoiding me. And I spent most of my day transferring my lab notebook very peacefully. Talking to people in the break room very peacefully. And to tell you how peaceful it was, I walked myself out of the building. They felt like I did not need a security escort." That's why that detail was important, because it kind of throws a wrench in Elizabeth's story.

Carolynn: Yeah, yeah. Did you also say, and I have 200 copies of an email that I could show you, it's right under my sweatshirt right now, grandpa?

Tyler: I did. I showed him the email. One of the many copies that I had, I gave to him.

Carolynn: Oh, by the way, had just printed the one you've sent to Elizabeth with all of the details? Or had you printed the entire thread-

Jessica: With Sonny?

Carolynn: With Sonny's response and you're like, "Okay, well I'm giving you two weeks notice." Did you have the whole conversation?

Tyler: Yes-

Jessica: So smart.

Tyler: ... The Whole conversation.

Jessica: It was so smart.

Tyler: And it's actually a really interesting email to read because Sonny put his responses in line with mine. So it almost reads like a conversation. Which is nice because it's not like you read one email and then you read a response. It really feels like there's a little bit of a back and forth.

And he read it, and again, he did not understand it. He said, "To me, it looks like they've given you a pretty substantive answer here. This is a lot of words." And I point out specific sentences. I would say, read this sentence. They're not addressing my concern. He's calling me stupid.

I can be stupid and my concern can still be valid. And it sounds like that resonated with him at least a little bit, because he said that he had been on the phone with Elizabeth all day. First of all, she said that I was completely wrong, that they were going above and beyond what was required of regulatory agencies, that they did a hundred percent of the testing on Theranos devices, that they were only doing finger pricks. She reiterated all that stuff. But he said, "She's trying to convince me that you're stupid and she can't do that. But she can convince me that you're wrong, and I believe that you're wrong." So it's like he almost got this idea that they weren't addressing my problem. They were just calling me stupid. But he didn't quite get there all the way.

Carolynn: So close. Well, so this is probably minor in comparison to all of the actually substantive points about the fraud, but at least I would think that email would show that she had lied about the way you quit. I mean, it's a small victory. But you could say, "Hey grandpa, look it. I am very professional and classy. I just gave my two weeks and said, "how can I help?" Whatever. So that's clearly just her bullshitting. And how come he couldn't be like, yeah, why'd she lie to me about that? I would've wanted that for you.

Tyler: At that point in time, it was impossible for him to see Elizabeth doing any wrongdoing. It was truly a cult leader talking to one of her followers. But at the end of that conversation, he just said, "Well move on to the next thing. This chapter is over."

Carolynn: Did you feel like that too? He's like, okay, okay. You quit. Today was your last day. Life goes on. Were you like, okay, I'm done with Theranos?

Tyler: Yeah. Well, the day's not quite done.

Carolynn: Okay. Okay. That's right.

Jessica: Oh! Dinner with Erika Chung.

Tyler: Yeah.

Carolynn: Okay. All right. Sorry.

Keep going. We got to keep going. Is this okay? Is that okay with you, Tyler?

Tyler: Yeah. Totally fine.

Carolynn: Okay. Because this is-

Tyler: I think we-re-

Carolynn: We're almost done. And let's, by the way, leave on a cliffhanger.

Tyler: Yeah. Okay. We can do that. We can do that for sure.

Jessica: Tyler's like, "Okay, give me a minute. Give me a minute."

Tyler: Well, the cliffhanger is really more like there's a clear eye of the storm where we're going to end.

Carolynn: Okay.

Jessica: Okay.

Tyler: So I don't know if that's quite a cliffhanger, but it's something.

Jessica: Eye of the storm is fine, but we'll tee it up like, and the second part is even worse. Because that's the point. It got even worse. You thought it was closure and it wasn't. Okay, so the day continues, right, Tyler?

Tyler: So the day continues. I leave my grandfather's office. I feel like I've left this thing behind me. My colleague Erika wants to chat. And so we decide to meet up for a beer at a bar a lot of people know as Antonio's Nut House, which unfortunately does not exist anymore, but still a lot of people know the place.

Jessica: I know. RIP Antonio's-

Carolynn: Just like Poke Sushi, we've all been to Antonio's.

Tyler: Yep, yep. The Nut House. And so we met up there, we had a beer. And Erika was just so frustrated when I had kind of recounted how my day went to her, and she had a lot of the very same concerns. And she said, "I want to raise the same concerns that you did." And she wanted to write an email just like I did, but she said that she went and talked to her manager about this, and he said, do not do that. And what she told me was that he said something like, "If you do this, you will be on their radar, and once you're on their radar, you will be there forever, and that's not somewhere you want to be."

And so she just felt totally discouraged. She's like, no one will listen to me. And I said, "I cannot guarantee that my grandfather will do anything, but I can guarantee that he will listen to you." For all of his flaws he is a very good listener. I said, "Would you want to talk to him tonight?" I said, actually, my grandfather invited me over to have dinner with him tonight. I'm sure I can bring you as a guest if you want to talk to him. She said, "Yeah, I would love to speak with him." And so I somehow reconnected with my grandfather and said, "Is it okay if I bring one of my colleagues over for dinner?" And he said, "Yes, that's awesome. Bring her over."

Jessica: And you probably saw her as an ally? Another voice telling my grandfather what I've been trying to tell him.

Tyler: I know. It's like, I wish I could have extended that invitation to the entire lab. And this is actually a very good lesson in corporate governance. Where I feel like if any of those people felt like they could safely talk to a board member, I bet a lot of people would've done it. They felt like they could anonymously go talk to a board member without Elizabeth and Sonny knowing what they're talking about, they probably would've wanted to talk to my grandfather. But they would not trust the confidentiality piece the way it was set up.

But yeah, so that night, Erika and I go back over to my grandfather's house. And it was a little bit odd because I felt like earlier in the day, he was almost... He was more calm. He seemed to be listening a bit more. By the time Erika had gotten there, I think Elizabeth had spoken to him more, and he had become almost angry at us. And I felt bad because I had promised Erika that he would listen to her, and he kind of shut her down. And I felt like I was frustrated because I felt like Erika was not raising the concerns that I wanted

her to tell him about. But I also can't blame her because she was definitely getting shut down by my grandfather and just told, you guys are young. You don't know what you're looking at. Elizabeth has assured me about all of these things. In that dinner, he even said that these devices were currently being used in Medevac helicopters in Afghanistan. He said, "You guys are dead wrong. These are being used in battlefields."

Carolynn: Wow. Oh my gosh.

Jessica: Wasn't there the military guy on the board? Mattis?

Tyler: Jim Mattis, yeah.

Jessica: Couldn't he have said, "George, they're not being used on the battlefield."

Tyler: That is what you think would happen. But that is not what happened. Somehow, I don't know how this happened. So I kind of apologize for some of the lack of details. But I do know in this documentary, they dug up a bunch of stuff, and they found a quote that was attributed to Jim Mattis. That was in drafts of marketing materials that Theranos used that undoubtedly my grandfather read. And that is where he got this information from.

I want to read this quote if we have time to include it. Because the quote itself is like a masterclass in how to lie. Because it just illustrates how good she really was. So this is the quote that was attributed to Jim Mattis, that I don't believe he ever said. I think Elizabeth probably made it up and put his name on it. It says, "We have been using Theranos for two years with incredible success. One of the most challenging parts of my job is contacting families of fallen soldiers. I write multiple next of kin letters every day. And so it is very evident to me the impact that Theranos has had on survival rates. We're able to take these small machines to the frontline on helicopters and planes. Test, get extremely accurate results and begin stabilization immediately. As a result, we have a 98% survival rate, up 30% from 68%. That's a dramatic improvement in the quality of care that we can provide the courageous men and women of our armed forces. Which means a lot more soldiers are going home to their families."

Carolynn: Wow, that is a masterclass.

Jessica: Carolyn, I'm going to answer your previous question and say yes, she is a psychopath.

Carolynn: She is a sociopath.

Jessica: Sociopath. Yeah.

Carolynn: That's-

Tyler: I feel like since this is recorded, and Sonny, he actually never settled his civil lawsuit, so we still have one more trial. I will say I have no direct knowledge of that quote. I don't know if Elizabeth made it up.

Jessica: Yep. Right.

Carolynn: Right.

Tyler: What I do know is that my grandfather parroted those exact same ideas to me. So he heard them from someone, from somewhere.

Carolynn: And Jim Mattis has never addressed this piece of it at all? Did he just kind of peace out on this whole thing?

Tyler: He kind of did, but Jim Mattis was the only board member that testified in Elizabeth's criminal trial.

Carolynn: For the government?

Jessica: For the government.

Tyler: For the government. And I'm glad that he had that opportunity because I know Jim Mattis has a really great reputation. When I've spoken to people who know him, you only hear high praise for Jim Mattis. And I don't think he did his job as a board member, but he was also taken advantage of, I believe. And so I'm glad that he had the opportunity to take the stand and testify against her, and to some extent, right some of the wrongs.

However, I don't believe that that absolves the board of the guilt that they should have.

Carolynn: Yeah. Yeah. That's fair.

Tyler: Yeah. So anyway, we're in this dinner. And again, I think everyone knows who Jim Mattis is, but at the time he was a four star general. He then became the Secretary of Defense. So when Elizabeth is making these types of claims to either other board members or to investors, and it's attributed to Jim Mattis, and you're an investor trying to diligence this claim. There is no person better in the world to know if that statement is true or false than Jim Mattis. There's no one else you should be able to turn to ask is this statement true or false? And so that is an example of the incredible credibility that Elizabeth had when she was in these pitches.

Carolynn: Amazing. All right, so back to the dinner.

Tyler: So back to the dinner. So my grandfather's parroting these claims, and he just says, you're dead wrong. And I said, "These devices are not working within the walls of Theranos. There's no chance this is working in a helicopter. And I want you to know that I'm going to say it as straightforward as I can possibly say it. This is not working in a helicopter. And when Elizabeth tells you lies. Tells you excuses about why they're not rolled out nationwide. When she keeps saying, it's coming, it's coming, it's coming. And it never does. Know that those excuses are lies and the real reason is that it doesn't work." And he just said, okay. And then we all left pretty frustrated. And then actually

outside my grandfather's house, Erika asked if she could see a copy of the email. So I showed her a copy of this email exchange.

Carolynn: You're like, hang on, hang on, I've got 200 copies.

Tyler: Yeah. She probably read the first two paragraphs and that just closed her eyes and said, I can't read this right now. I'm just too tired.

And then she went in the next day and she quit. And she did not send the email she wanted to send. But I think she did have a face-to-face discussion with Sonny on her last day. And then that next day for me, I felt like a huge weight had been lifted. I thought Theranos is finally behind me, this horrible chapter that was eight months that felt like an absolute eternity. I just felt so alive. The sun was out. I walked on campus, I saw some friends actually, I went to the bookstore and I bought a book and I just thought, I'm just going to take time to sit in the sun and read this book. And then my parents lived pretty close and I drove down to Los Gatos to see my mom. And we just had this idea of going to the nursery and buying an avocado tree and planting it in the backyard. So we spent the day digging a hole, planting this avocado tree.

Carolynn: By the way, are you thinking like, "Hey, I am going to probably go get my PhD?" Or were you just not even thinking about the future yet?

Tyler: Yeah, so I really wanted to go back and work in a lab at Stanford with a professor that I had taken a class from when I was an undergrad.

I really wanted to go do that. I didn't know if it was going to happen yet, but I was trying to get into his lab. And when I worked at Theranos, I was trying to set that up as the next step. His advice to me was, Theranos seems like it's a really great company. You should try to stick it out. You should.

In his defense, I was not sharing with him all of these details. And he said, it's your first job. It could look bad if you leave after just a few months. You should try to stay the whole year. So when I asked if I could join his lab, his first answer was kind of like, no, you should stick it out. And then I re-approached him and I said, I've already quit. So that piece is out of the equation. Can I just come join your lab now as I'm looking for my next thing to do? And he welcomed me into his lab.

Carolynn: That's great. But just to reiterate, it's a memorably great day you're having the day after Theranos. And it's memorable because of what happens next. But it's just kind of funny that you have all these memories of-

Jessica: Happy memories. Yeah,

Tyler: It was such a beautiful day. I exercised. I read some. I spent time with my mom. I planted a tree. And it felt like this huge relief for my parents as well. We all just felt like, oh, this is over. This was such a horrible chapter. We're glad it's closed. Not realizing that this was really the beginning.

Jessica: So the three of us have agreed that we are going to pick up the second half of Tyler's story in another episode. Because there's just so many details. But Tyler, I want you to tell us when did part two kick off? What was the moment you knew, "oh wait".

Carolynn: This isn't over.

Jessica: This isn't over

Tyler: Probably. Well, one of those moments was when I had to have Thanksgiving dinner with Elizabeth. After all this.

Jessica: Oh, gosh.

Tyler: That was a moment. But the moment when I realized this is a really big problem, is when I became aware that Theranos knew that I was a source for the Wall Street Journal. That's when I knew, this is going to be bad.

Carolynn: So let's then for the next episode, pick up at Thanksgiving dinner. And the next episode is going to be all about the whistle blowing, and the Wall Street Journal, and the downfall of Theranos. Thank you for sharing all of this with us. It was absolutely fascinating and I can't wait to hear the second part.

Jessica: Same.

Tyler: Yeah. Thank you. This was really interesting for me as well.

Carolynn: All right-

Jessica: Thanks, Tyler.

Carolynn: We'll talk soon then, Tyler.

Tyler: All right, talk to you later.

Carolynn: Bye.

Jessica: Bye.

Tyler: Bye.